GLASSHOUSE

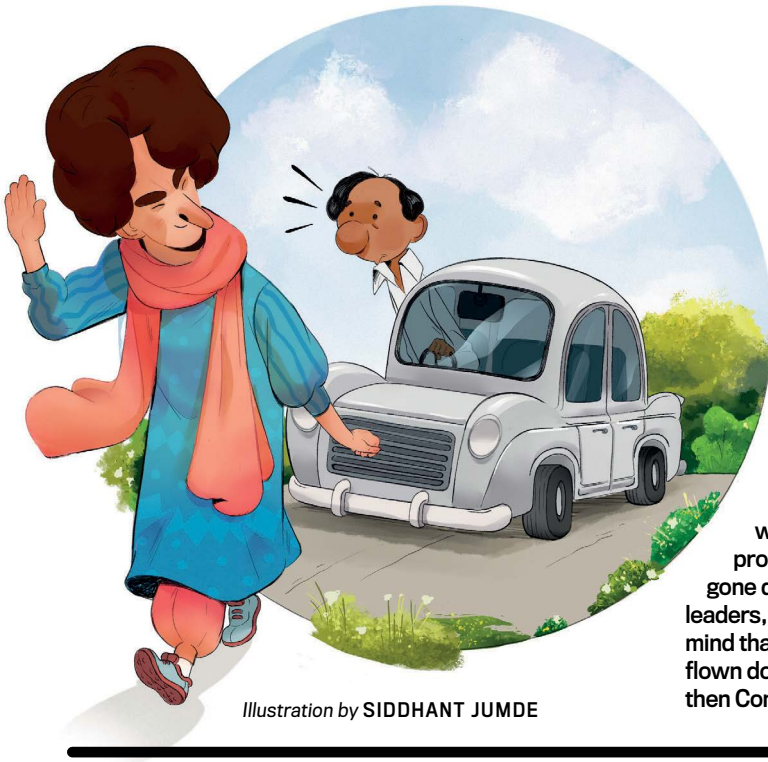


Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

KARNATAKA REDUX IN TELANGANA?

Enthused by the Karnataka results, Congress workers in Telangana are hoping the party will recreate the magic there as well in the assembly election later this year. And they are looking to party general secretary **Priyanka Gandhi** to lead the revival. Suggestions now include her getting a guesthouse in Hyderabad to even contesting the 2024 general election from Medak, from where her grandmother Indira Gandhi won in 1980. The prospect of a Gandhi leading the Congress campaign has not gone down well with the ruling Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) leaders, who dismiss the Gandhis as "political tourists". Never mind that party supremo K. Chandrashekar Rao had, in 2014, flown down to Delhi to personally thank Priyanka's mother and then Congress chief Sonia Gandhi after Telangana got statehood.



FRIENDS IN NEED

Desperate for a comeback, TDP supremo **N. Chandrababu Naidu** is trying to stitch up an alliance in Andhra Pradesh for the 2024 assembly election. Actor Pawan Kalyan's Jana Sena is onboard, but Naidu is eager to rope in the BJP too. He met Union home minister Amit Shah in Delhi on June 3, the first time after the TDP exited the NDA in 2018. The saffron party is reportedly eager to keep both Naidu and CM Jagan Mohan Reddy's YSRCP in good humour. Never know when you'll need the numbers, especially with a general election coming up.

ALL FOR OPTICS





Madhya Pradesh chief minister **Shivraj Singh Chouhan**'s flamboyant brother-in-law, **Sanjay Singh Masani**, is stirring up the pot again. Masani, who has even done a few cameos in films, was in the BJP till 2018, but switched over to the Congress just before the election after he was given a ticket from the Waraseoni seat in Balaghat district. Masani lost rather badly and is now learnt to be focusing his political energies in the Udaipura seat in Raisen district, not too far from Bhopal. Why? Word is that Masani has family there and his community, the Kirars, are also present in large numbers. The only problem is that veteran Congressman Devendra Patel is the incumbent MLA here. Will the Congress oblige Masani again, give him a ticket for the sake of optics?

IT'S GETTING VERSE

Punjab chief minister **Bhagwant Mann** is going back to his first love—political satire—to target rivals. The first salvo was a poem, blasting them for backing the owner of a prominent media house whom Mann wants the vigilance bureau to investigate. His rivals, like Bikramjit Majithia (Akali Dal), Navjot Sidhu (INC) and Subhash Sharma (BJP), have hit back with lines a tad more venomous. Punjab politics is becoming 'verse' than before.





A TRUSTED LIEUTENANT

Sunil Bansal, the BJP national general secretary who played a key role in the party's superlative performance in Uttar Pradesh in the last two Lok Sabha and assembly polls, is back in the state again. He was earlier given charge of the 16 LS seats the party lost in 2019, but now also heads the newly-launched central programme, Jan Sampark Abhiyaan, in UP. It looks like the BJP wants to improve its strike rate further in India's biggest state.

Kaushik Deka with Amarnath K. Menon, Rahul Noronha, Anilesh S. Mahajan and Ashish Misra